Interview "Tips and Traps" Job Aid

Overview: This guide provides actionable guidance on navigating disability disclosure in interviews in a respectful, inclusive way.

Topic	Trap	Tip
Diagnosis	**"What is your diagnosis?"** *Asking about a candidate's diagnosis focuses on private medical information.*	**"Do you have any questions for us about our accommodations or disability policies? We want to ensure you have access to all information when making your rank list."** *Focus on inclusion and support. This opens the door for candidates to ask questions without feeling forced to share information they may not be comfortable disclosing.*
Time 0ff	**"Do you anticipate needing time off?"** *Even well-intentioned questions about needing time off can reflect assumptions.*	**"If you need accommodations during residency, our office will work with you and the disability office/HR to determine and provide them."** *This offers a clear pathway for support and eliminates assumptions.*
Accommodations	**"What types of accommodations will you need?"** *The topic of accommodations may come up during an interview. Even if a candidate inquires about accommodations, asking for additional details they do not disclose could make them feel judged.*	**"We provide reasonable accommodations and are happy to work with residents and [office responsible for accommodations] to go through the process proactively, so that residents can begin their training with full access."** *This phrasing avoids presuming disability, emphasizes support, and communicates a proactive, inclusive approach.*
Scheduling Questions	**"Do you have concerns about being able to handle the schedule?** *This links disability to workload ability.*	**"If you require any modifications to the schedule or considerations for times/days off, please let us know early in the process to facilitate coverage."** *This focuses on essential functions, not assumptions about capacity.*

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